

ADVANCED SYSTEMS LAB · TEAM 41 · FINAL

Interval-Masked Streaming Top-k Pearson Correlation

Recap on memory hierarchy optimizations
+ *memory layout sorting optimization*

0.06 $\rightarrow$ $\approx$ 10 FLOPs/cyc (LONG) $\approx$ 10 FLOPs/cyc (SHORT) 9 incremental improvements

Recap

Matrix $X \in \mathbb{R}^{F \times S}$ — each feature i valid only on $[\text{start}_i, \text{end}_i)$.

- For every feature, find the $K = 16$ others with the largest $\rho_{I_i[\dots], I_j[\dots]}$
- Overlap $L = \max(\text{start}_i, \text{start}_j)$, $R = \min(\text{end}_i, \text{end}_j)$
- $\text{corr}(i, j) = \frac{1}{R - L - 1} \sum_{t=L}^{R-1} z_i(t) z_j(t)$
- R1: never materialize the full $F \times F$ matrix $\rightarrow$ streaming top- K heap



3 phases, 1 bottleneck

Phase 1: Normalize

μ_i, σ_i per feature $\rightarrow$ z -scores, once

3.4% of cycles

Phase 2: Correlate

z -score dot product over every overlap
 $[L, R)$

96.6% of cycles

Phase 3: Top-K

min-heap insert per pair

0.1% of cycles

```
// Phase 2 inner loop
float acc = 0.0f;
for (uint32_t t = L; t < R; ++t)
    acc += Z[i*S + t] * Z[j*S + t];
corr = acc / (R - L - 1);
```

Microbenchmark (PAPI, $F=128$, $S=8192$):

Phase 2 = **96.6%** of cycles

Optimizations all focus on this dot product.

Measurement: growing warm-up batches prime branch predictors & reach steady state, then every input buffer + scratch is `CLFLUSH` + `MFENCE` 'd before each timed call — **numbers start from a cold cache.**

Incremental optimizations

V0 Baseline naive reference, -O3 0.2×

V1 Logical Baseline pre-normalize · upper-triangle · min-heap -O0 1×

V2 Auto-vectorization -O3 -march=native 2.6×

V3 Fast-math + ILP · V4 Manual ILP reorder + unroll ~3×

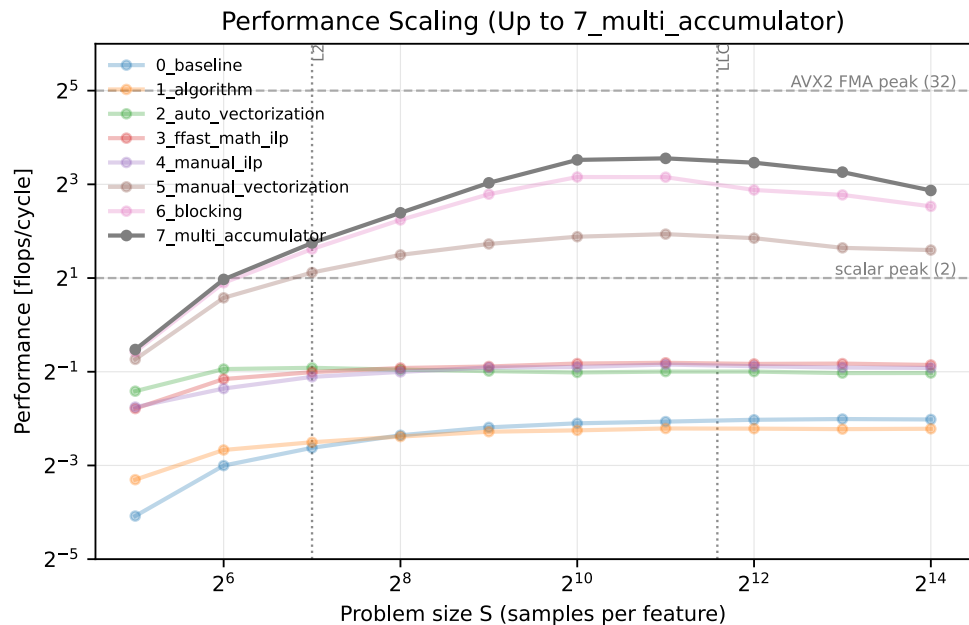
V5 Manual AVX2 8 FMAs/inst 19×

V6 Reg. blocking 4×1 · V7 Multi-acc 4×2 hide FMA lat → ≈ 10 FLOPs/cyc 47×

V8 Sorting order feat. by interval overlap **new contribution** 53×

cumulative speedup vs logical baseline V1 · LONG_GAUSSIAN, $F=2048$, $S=512$

Improving from V7



V7 = 8 accumulators (4×2)

Saturates the 2 FMA ports →

$$\approx 10\text{FLOPs/cyc} \approx \frac{1}{3}\pi_{\text{peak}}$$

- Inner loop close to optimal (microarch.)
- But touches **every feature pair** and re-walk overlaps blindly
- Dip at $S=2^{14}$: $Z = 8\text{MB} > 6\text{MB L3} \rightarrow$ DRAM-bound

Untouched lever: the **overlap structure**.

What if we reorder the data to exploit it?

NEW IMPROVEMENT

V8: Sort features by interval

Permute rows $\rightarrow$ `start[i]` monotone

2 big benefits

Why sorting pays off

1. Monotone starts $\rightarrow$ early exit

Sorted `start[]` non-decreasing.

For i -block with $E = \max \text{end}[i]$:

$\text{start}[j] \geq E \Rightarrow$ no more overlap

$\rightarrow$ `break` loop

```
uint32_t E = max(end[i..i+3]);
for (j = i+4; ...; j += 2) {
    if (starts[j] >= E) break; // exit
    /* 8-acc 4x2 dot products */
}
```

In `GAUSSIAN_SHORT`, most disjoint $\rightarrow$ skipped

2: Overlap cluster $\rightarrow$ cache locality

Adjacent intervals similar $[L, R)$:

- cluster by overlap $\rightarrow$ strip of Z hot in L1/L2
- `L ... R` tail loop shrink (less redundancy)
- contiguous sorted rows
 $\rightarrow$ prefetch-friendly strides

Unsorted:

```
Iter 1: [==]
Iter 2:           [==]
Iter 3:         [==]
Iter 4:           [==]
```

Sorted:

```
Iter 1: [==]
Iter 2: [==]
Iter 3: [==]
Iter 4: [==]
```

V8 permutation implementation

```
// step 1: sort by start
for (i) perm[i] = i;
std::sort(perm, perm+F, [&](a,b){start[a] < start[b]});
for (si) {           // cache sorted bounds
    sorted_starts[si] = starts[perm[si]];
    sorted_ends[si]   = ends[perm[si]];
}
```

```
// step 2: normalize, read original row
//           perm[si], write sorted row si
Z[si*S + t] = (X[perm[si]*S+t] - mean) * inv_std;
```

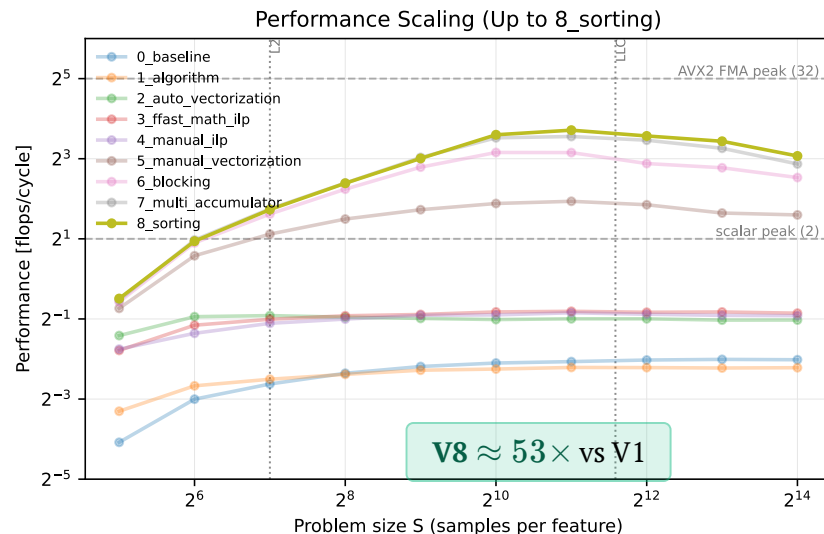
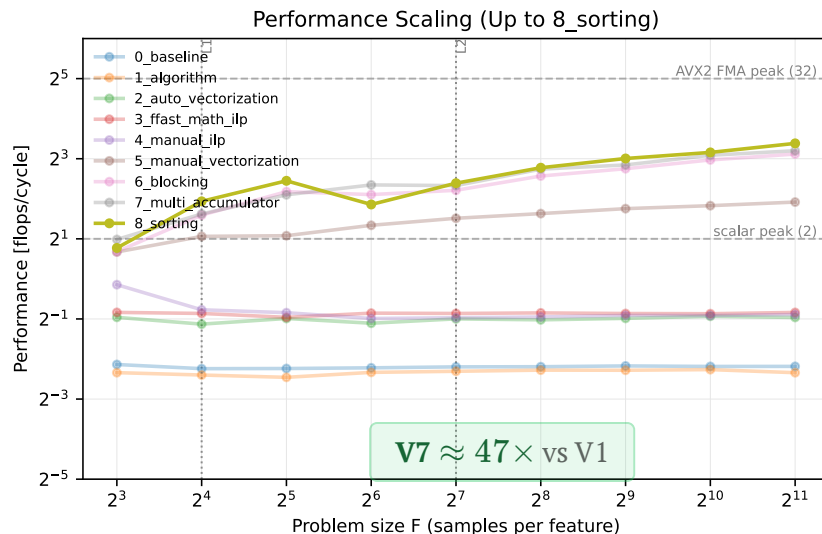
```
// step 3: sorted-space dot-prod: orig. idx → heap
heap_insert(&heaps[i*K], v, perm[j]);
```

```
// step 4: scatter through perm
heap_to_topK(&heaps[si*K], &topK[perm[si]*K]);
```

Output identical to V7; permutation only internal. Early-exit reduces FLOPs – depends on domain.

LONG_GAUSSIAN (default)

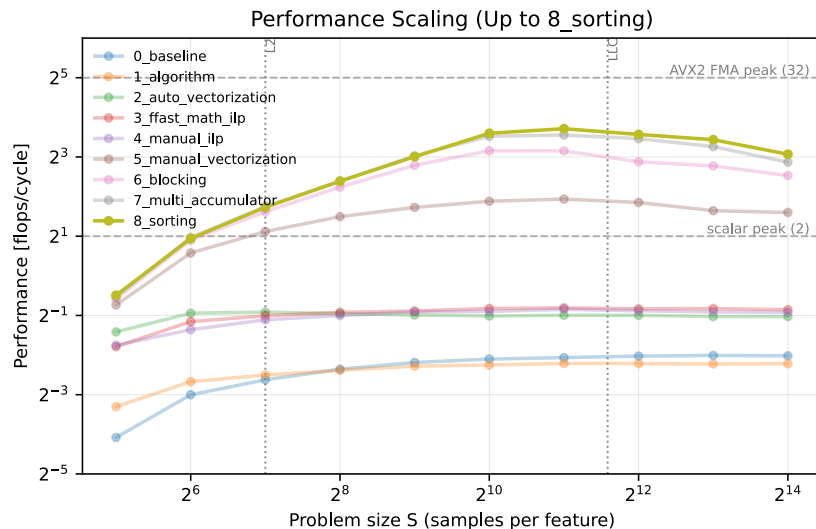
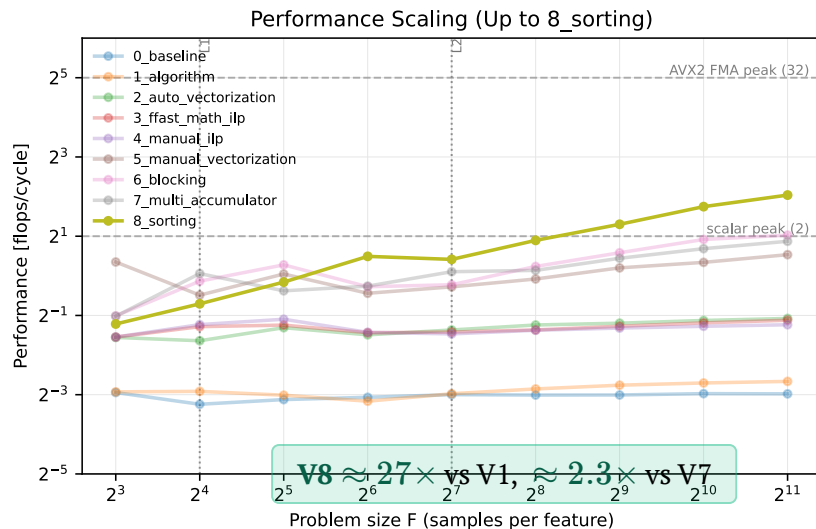
Performance vs F (left, $S=512$) and vs S (right, $F=512$)



- LONG : 80% intervals $\rightarrow$ most overlap
- Early-exit rare
- Cache locality $\rightarrow$ still $\approx 5\text{--}13\%$ faster at large F

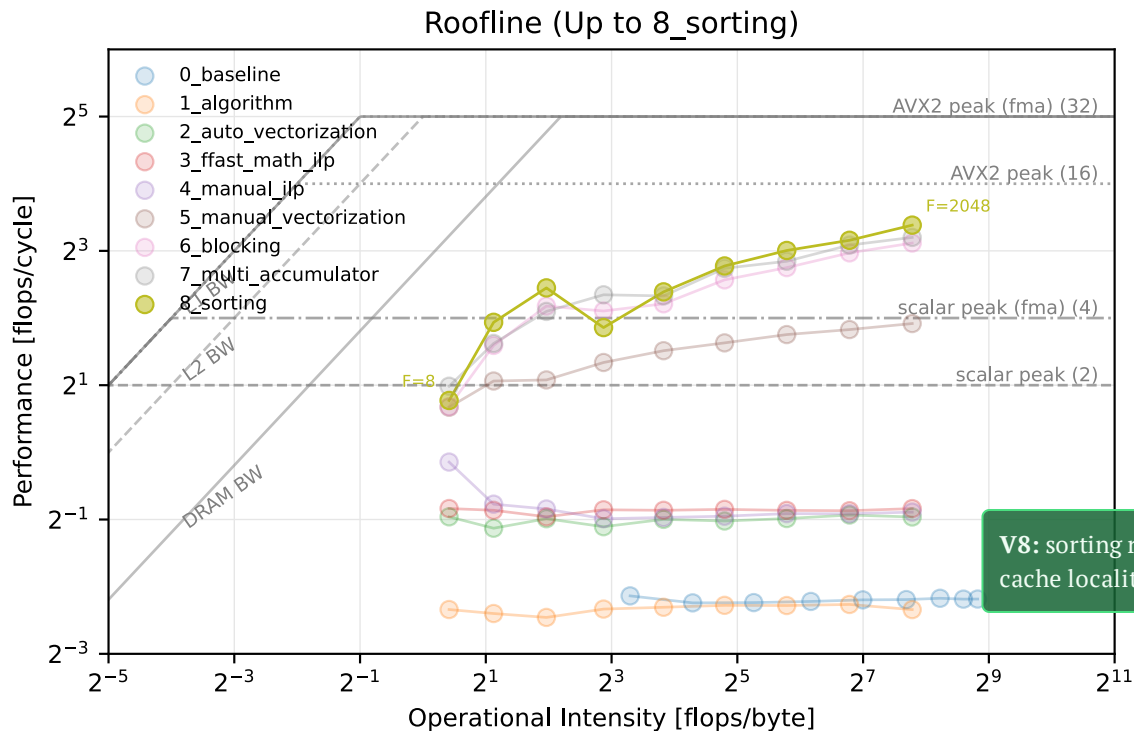
SHORT_GAUSSIAN (sorting wins)

Performance: F (left, $S=512$) vs S (right, $F=512$)



- Reaches ≈ 16 FLOPs/cyc
- SHORT : 30% intervals $\rightarrow$ mostly disjoint, early-exit prunes
- V7 computes every pair; V8 does not — pure work removed

Rooflines

Operational intensity vs performance, sweep over F ($S=512$)

V8: sorting raises block- I -overlap $\rightarrow$ cache locality

Summary

96.6%

of cycles one dot-product, seen in
micro-benchmarks

$\approx 10 \rightarrow 16$ FLOPs/cyc

V7 micro-arch peak $\rightarrow$ V8 sort
in SHORT

53 $\times$ / 27 $\times$

V8 LONG / SHORT
at $F=2048$ vs logical baseline

- **Meetings 1–2:** micro-architectural improvements (SIMD $\rightarrow$ blocking $\rightarrow$ 8 accumulators)
- **New:** data layout improvement – sort by interval
- Regime-dependent: invisible in LONG , significant in SHORT ; adaptivity adheres to R2.

Questions

Team 41

i7-7700HQ (Kaby Lake) · core-pinned, turbo off · PAPI harness · warm branch pred., cold cache